

DAYANANDA SAGAR COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING

(An Autonomous Institute affiliated to Visvesvaraya Technological University (VTU), Belagavi,
Approved by AICTE and UGC, Accredited by NAAC with 'A' grade & ISO 9001 – 2015 Certified Institution)
Shavige Malleshwara Hills, Kumaraswamy Layout, Bengaluru-560 111, India

DEPT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE & ENGINEERING (CYBERSECURITY)

(Accredited by NBA Tier 1)



A Report on

Internship (Industry/Research)

(22CY82)

Undergone at

Cognizant

As

Cybersecurity Intern

Submitted in partial fulfillment for the award of the degree of

Bachelor of Engineering

in

Computer Science and Engineering (Cybersecurity)

Submitted by

Tanu Rajput

(1DS22CY056)

Under the Guidance of

Prof. Mangala L

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Academic Year 2025 - 26

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DEPARTMENT OF CSE-CYBER SECURITY

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CERTIFICATE

Certified that the internship titled **“Cybersecurity Intern”** is a Bonafide work carried out by **Tanu Rajput** bearing USN: **1DS22CY056**, from **31st January 2026 to 18th May 2026** at **“Cognizant”** in partial fulfillment for the award of Bachelor of Engineering in CSE-Cyber Security at Dayananda Sagar College of Engineering affiliated to Visvesvaraya Technological University, Belagavi.

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DECLARATION

I, **Tanu Rajput** bearing the USN-**1DS22CY056** hereby declare that I have prepared the internship report on my reference to the standard textbooks/reference books and related web portals & have not copied it from any other students.

Tanu Rajput

1DS22CY056

Place: Bengaluru

Date: 08-05-2026

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

The internship opportunity I had with **Cognizant** was a great chance for learning and professional development. Therefore, I consider myself a very lucky individual as I was provided with an opportunity to be a part of it. I am also grateful for having a chance to meet so many wonderful people and professionals who led me through this internship period.

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Sincerely,
Tanu Rajput
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ABSTRACT

This internship report presents a detailed overview of the knowledge, practical exposure, and technical experience gained during the 3.5-month cybersecurity internship undertaken at Cognizant. The internship was conducted at the Cognizant Siruseri campus, Chennai, where the primary focus was on understanding enterprise cybersecurity operations, cloud technologies, threat monitoring practices, and security fundamentals used in modern IT infrastructures.

The internship provided exposure to multiple domains including computer networks, malware analysis, cloud computing, cloud security, security monitoring, and incident response concepts. The training program combined theoretical learning with practical activities and hands-on tasks using industry-standard tools such as Microsoft Defender, Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk, Microsoft Azure, and Amazon Web Services (AWS). The internship also included foundational programming exposure in Java and Python to strengthen logical thinking, scripting ability, and understanding of cybersecurity automation.

Throughout the internship period, several concepts related to cybersecurity operations were studied, including threat detection, vulnerability identification, malware behavior analysis, log monitoring, cloud infrastructure security, and basic incident analysis workflows. The internship helped in understanding how organizations maintain secure enterprise environments and respond to modern cyber threats using centralized monitoring systems and cloud-based security solutions.

The internship significantly improved technical knowledge, analytical thinking, communication skills, problem-solving abilities, and understanding of professional work culture. It also provided valuable insights into real-world cybersecurity challenges faced by organizations operating at a global scale. The overall experience contributed greatly toward academic learning as well as professional development in the field of cybersecurity.

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1. INTRODUCTION

Cybersecurity has become one of the most critical and rapidly evolving domains in the modern digital world due to the exponential growth of internet technologies, cloud computing, artificial intelligence, digital transformation, and interconnected enterprise systems. Organizations across industries such as banking, healthcare, education, manufacturing, e-commerce, and government services rely heavily on digital infrastructure for business operations, communication, financial transactions, remote collaboration, customer relationship management, and data storage. The increasing dependence on technology has significantly improved operational efficiency and accessibility, but at the same time it has also increased the complexity of cyber threats faced by organizations worldwide. Humanity built a globally connected digital ecosystem and then acted surprised when attackers also received an invitation. Truly a breathtaking level of optimism.

As technology evolves, cyber threats such as malware attacks, phishing campaigns, ransomware incidents, insider threats, distributed denial-of-service (DDoS) attacks, data breaches, identity theft, social engineering, and unauthorized access attempts have also increased dramatically. Attackers continuously develop sophisticated techniques to exploit vulnerabilities in software, networks, cloud environments, and user behavior. Cybercriminals often target organizations for financial gain, espionage, political influence, disruption of services, or theft of confidential information. The rapid increase in cyberattacks has forced organizations to prioritize cybersecurity as a fundamental requirement rather than an optional investment.

To protect organizational systems, sensitive data, intellectual property, and customer information, companies invest heavily in cybersecurity technologies, Security Operations Centers (SOCs), cloud security platforms, endpoint protection systems, identity and access management solutions, and skilled cybersecurity professionals capable of monitoring and responding to threats effectively. Modern organizations require continuous monitoring, vulnerability assessment, incident response planning, and threat intelligence analysis to maintain secure business environments. As a result, the demand for cybersecurity professionals has increased significantly across the global technology industry.

2. COMPANY/ORGANIZATION PROFILE

2.1 About Cognizant

Cognizant is a leading multinational information technology services and consulting company headquartered in Teaneck, New Jersey, United States. The company was originally founded in Chennai, India, in 1994 and has since grown into one of the world's major IT service providers with operations across multiple countries and regions. Over the years, Cognizant has established a strong global presence by delivering innovative technological solutions and business services to organizations belonging to diverse industrial sectors.

Cognizant is widely recognized for its client-centric approach, strong technical expertise, and ability to deliver scalable enterprise solutions. The organization continuously invests in emerging technologies, innovation, workforce development, and research initiatives to remain competitive in the global IT industry. Its focus on continuous learning and technological advancement allows the company to provide efficient and future-ready solutions to clients worldwide.

2.2 Nature of Business

Cognizant primarily operates in the fields of:

- Information Technology Services
- IT Consulting
- Digital Transformation
- Cloud Computing
- Artificial Intelligence and Data Analytics
- Cybersecurity Services
- Software Development and Testing
- Infrastructure Management
- Business Process Services
- Enterprise Application Services
- Automation and DevOps Solutions

The organization also focuses heavily on digital engineering and transformation services, enabling businesses to integrate advanced technologies such as machine learning, predictive analytics, robotic process automation (RPA), and Internet of Things (IoT) solutions into their operations. These services help organizations improve decision-making, reduce operational costs, and enhance customer engagement.

Another important aspect of Cognizant's business operations is consulting and strategic planning. The company works closely with clients to analyze business challenges, identify technological requirements, and design solutions aligned with organizational goals. This combination of technical expertise and business consulting enables Cognizant to provide end-to-end solutions for enterprise customers.

2.3 Industries Served

Cognizant provides services to various industries including:

- Healthcare
- Banking and Financial Services
- Retail and E-Commerce
- Manufacturing
- Insurance
- Telecommunications
- Energy and Utilities
- Life Sciences
- Media and Entertainment
- Logistics and Transportation
- Education and Technology Services

The company's ability to support multiple industries demonstrates its large-scale operational capabilities and technological expertise. Different industries face unique technological and cybersecurity challenges, and Cognizant develops industry-specific solutions to address those requirements effectively.

2.4 Organizational Structure

Cognizant follows a well-structured organizational hierarchy designed to ensure efficient management, effective communication, collaboration, and smooth execution of projects across departments. The organizational structure enables teams to coordinate efficiently while maintaining high standards of quality, security, and productivity in project delivery.

The company includes various divisions such as:

- Human Resources
- Cybersecurity and Security Operations
- Software Development Teams
- Cloud Infrastructure Teams
- Project Management Teams
- Technical Support Teams
- Data Analytics Teams
- Research and Innovation Departments
- Quality Assurance and Testing Teams
- Business Consulting Teams

Each department performs specialized functions while collaborating with other teams to achieve organizational objectives and deliver client solutions successfully. Technical teams work together with project managers, consultants, analysts, and support staff to ensure efficient project execution and timely delivery of services.

3. OBJECTIVES OF THE INTERNSHIP

The internship was undertaken with the primary objective of gaining practical exposure to cybersecurity concepts, enterprise security tools, cloud technologies, and real-world IT security practices followed in large organizations.

The major objectives of the internship are listed below:

- To understand the fundamentals of cybersecurity and enterprise security operations.
- To gain practical exposure to cloud computing platforms such as Microsoft Azure and Amazon Web Services (AWS).
- To learn the fundamentals of security monitoring and threat detection using enterprise security tools.
- To understand malware analysis concepts, attack techniques, and basic threat identification methodologies.
- To develop programming knowledge in Java and Python for logical thinking, scripting, and automation purposes.
- To understand computer networking concepts and their relevance in cybersecurity operations.
- To gain exposure to SIEM (Security Information and Event Management) platforms such as Microsoft Sentinel and Splunk.
- To understand how organizations monitor logs, analyze alerts, investigate incidents, and identify suspicious activities.
- To improve analytical thinking and problem-solving skills through technical assignments, case studies, and practical activities.
- To understand cloud security principles and the importance of securing enterprise cloud environments.
- To learn industry-standard cybersecurity practices followed in professional environments.

Overall, the internship served as a strong foundation for understanding enterprise cybersecurity environments, modern security operations, cloud technologies, and practical threat monitoring techniques.

4. INTERNSHIP ACTIVITIES AND TASKS PERFORMED

The internship involved various technical learning activities, practical sessions, assignments, and exposure to enterprise cybersecurity concepts. The tasks performed during the internship focused on strengthening foundational knowledge and understanding real-world security operations.

4.1 Learning Programming Fundamentals

One of the initial activities during the internship involved learning the fundamentals of programming using Java and Python.

Java

Java concepts covered during the internship included:

- Object-Oriented Programming (OOP)
- Classes and Objects
- Inheritance
- Polymorphism
- Encapsulation
- Exception Handling
- Arrays and Loops
- Basic File Handling

Learning Java helped in understanding structured programming principles and logical problem-solving approaches.

Python

Python learning included:

- Variables and Data Types
- Conditional Statements
- Loops and Functions

- Lists, Tuples, and Dictionaries
- File Handling
- Basic Automation Concepts
- Introduction to Scripting

Python is widely used in cybersecurity for automation, data analysis, and security scripting. Understanding Python fundamentals provided insight into how automation simplifies repetitive security tasks.

4.2 Understanding Computer Networks

The internship included learning foundational concepts related to computer networks and network security.

Topics studied included:

- OSI Model
- TCP/IP Protocol Suite
- IP Addressing
- Routing and Switching Basics
- DNS and DHCP
- HTTP and HTTPS
- Network Devices
- Firewalls and Proxies
- Secure Communication Concepts

Understanding computer networks is essential in cybersecurity because most attacks target network communication channels, servers, or connected devices.

4.3 Cloud Computing and Cloud Security

The internship provided exposure to cloud computing platforms including Microsoft Azure and Amazon Web Services (AWS).

Microsoft Azure

Learning activities related to Azure included:

- Understanding Azure Cloud Services
- Basics of Virtual Machines
- Storage Services
- Identity and Access Management
- Cloud Security Concepts
- Monitoring and Resource Management

Amazon Web Services (AWS)

AWS-related learning included:

- Introduction to AWS Services
- EC2 and Cloud Infrastructure Basics
- Storage Services
- Cloud Networking Fundamentals
- Security Concepts in AWS

Cloud computing has become essential for modern organizations due to scalability, flexibility, and cost efficiency. At the same time, cloud environments introduce security challenges such as unauthorized access, insecure configurations, and data exposure. The internship helped in understanding how organizations secure cloud environments using proper monitoring, access control, and security practices.

4.4 Microsoft Defender

Microsoft Defender was used to understand enterprise security monitoring and endpoint protection concepts.

Learning activities included:

- Monitoring security alerts
- Understanding endpoint security
- Threat detection concepts
- Malware and suspicious activity monitoring
- Basic alert investigation
- Understanding security dashboards

Exposure to Microsoft Defender helped in understanding how organizations protect systems against malware, suspicious behavior, and unauthorized activities.

4.5 Microsoft Sentinel

Microsoft Sentinel, a cloud-native SIEM and security analytics platform, was studied during the internship.

Activities performed included:

- Understanding SIEM architecture
- Log monitoring concepts
- Alert management
- Threat detection workflows
- Basic incident analysis
- Understanding security incidents and alerts

Microsoft Sentinel helps organizations collect, analyze, and monitor logs from multiple systems and devices. The internship provided practical understanding of how centralized monitoring improves threat visibility and incident response.

4.6 Splunk Fundamentals

Basic exposure to Splunk was also provided during the internship.

Learning included:

- Log analysis concepts
- Data ingestion basics
- Searching and filtering logs
- Understanding dashboards
- Event monitoring concepts

Splunk is widely used for analyzing machine-generated data and security logs. Exposure to Splunk helped in understanding how organizations investigate events and monitor suspicious activities using large-scale log analysis.

4.7 Malware Analysis Fundamentals

The internship also introduced malware analysis concepts and threat identification techniques.

Topics studied included:

- Types of Malware
- Trojan Horses
- Worms and Viruses
- Ransomware Concepts
- Spyware and Adware
- Malware Behavior Analysis
- Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)
- Attack Techniques and Tactics

Understanding malware behavior is essential for identifying potential threats and implementing appropriate security measures.

4.8 Participation in Technical Assignments

Throughout the internship, various assignments and learning exercises were conducted to strengthen practical understanding.

Activities included:

- Security-related learning exercises
- Cloud platform practice tasks
- Monitoring and analysis activities
- Technical assessments
- Tool familiarization exercises

These activities improved technical confidence, logical reasoning, and understanding of cybersecurity workflows.

Table 1: Internship Activities and Tasks Performed

Sl. No.	Activity / Task	Description	Tools / Technologies Used	Skills Developed	Duration (Approx.)
1.	Onboarding & Orientation	Attended company orientation, security policy training, and introduction to cybersecurity operations and tools used in enterprise environments.	Cognizant Learning Platform, MS Teams	Organizational awareness, Security policies understanding	1 Week
2.	Learning Programming Fundamentals	Strengthened Object Oriented Programming concepts using Java and Python through hands-on exercises and coding labs.	Java (JDK, IntelliJ IDEA), Python (VS Code, PIP)	OOP concepts, Problem solving, Code debugging	3 Weeks
3.	Cloud Computing & Security Concepts	Studied cloud models, virtualization, IAM, and security best practices on Microsoft Azure and AWS.	Microsoft Azure Portal, AWS Management Console	Cloud fundamentals, IAM, Security groups, Encryption concepts	4 Weeks
4.	Network Fundamentals & Security	Learnt core networking concepts, protocols, firewalls, VPN, IDS/IPS and secure network architecture.	Wireshark, Cisco Packet Tracer, Microsoft Networking tools	Network analysis, Traffic capture, Security concepts	3 Weeks
5.	Security Monitoring with Microsoft Defender	Monitored endpoints, analyzed alerts, and investigated incidents using Microsoft Defender for Endpoint.	Microsoft Defender for Endpoint	Alert triage, Incident analysis, Threat detection	4 Weeks
6.	SIEM Monitoring with Microsoft Sentinel	Created workbooks, queries and monitored security events, performed correlation and alert analysis.	Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), Log Analytics Workspace	Log analysis, KQL queries, Correlation rules	4 Weeks
7.	Log Analysis with Splunk	Imported logs, created searches and dashboards, and analyzed security events using Splunk.	Splunk Enterprise, Splunk Search Processing Language (SPL)	Log parsing, SPL queries, Dashboard creation	3 Weeks
8.	Malware Analysis Fundamentals	Studied malware types, static and dynamic analysis, behavior analysis using sandbox environments.	VirusTotal, Any.Run, Hybrid Analysis	Malware behavior analysis, Indicators of Compromise (IoCs)	3 Weeks
9.	Mini Project & Documentation	Worked on a mini project involving alert investigation workflow and documented the findings.	All above tools, MS Word, MS Excel	Documentation, Reporting, End-to-end analysis	3 Weeks
Total Duration of Internship			3.5 Months (Approx.)		

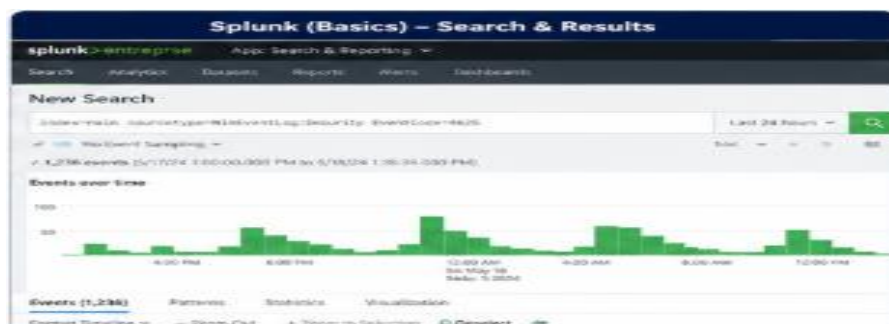


Fig 1- Splunk monitoring tool

5. LEARNING OUTCOMES

The internship provided significant technical and professional learning outcomes that contributed toward overall development in the field of cybersecurity.

5.1 Technical Knowledge Gained

The internship strengthened understanding of multiple technical domains including:

- Cybersecurity Fundamentals
- Computer Networks
- Cloud Computing
- Cloud Security
- Threat Detection
- Security Monitoring
- Malware Analysis
- SIEM Platforms
- Log Analysis Concepts

The exposure to enterprise tools and workflows improved understanding of how cybersecurity operations are managed in large organizations.

5.2 Practical Skills Acquired

Practical exposure during the internship helped in developing hands-on skills such as:

- Monitoring security alerts
- Understanding security dashboards
- Analyzing logs and events
- Identifying suspicious activities
- Understanding incident workflows
- Navigating cloud platforms
- Using SIEM tools

These skills are essential for cybersecurity roles related to security operations, monitoring, and cloud security.

5.3 Understanding Enterprise Security Operations

One of the major outcomes of the internship was understanding how enterprise organizations maintain cybersecurity operations.

This included:

- Continuous monitoring of systems
- Centralized log collection
- Threat detection processes
- Security alert management
- Cloud infrastructure security
- Endpoint protection mechanisms

The internship helped in understanding the importance of proactive monitoring and rapid incident response.

5.4 Exposure to Industry Tools

The internship provided valuable exposure to tools widely used in the cybersecurity industry, including:

- Microsoft Defender
- Microsoft Sentinel
- Splunk
- Microsoft Azure
- Amazon Web Services (AWS)

Understanding these platforms improved technical awareness regarding modern cybersecurity technologies.

5.5 Analytical and Problem-Solving Skills

The internship improved analytical thinking through:

- Technical assignments
- Log analysis activities
- Monitoring exercises
- Understanding attack patterns
- Interpreting security alerts

Cybersecurity requires the ability to analyze information carefully and identify abnormal behavior patterns. The internship strengthened this mindset considerably.

5.6 Challenges Faced and Solutions

During the internship, certain challenges were encountered while understanding complex cybersecurity concepts and enterprise tools.

Challenges:

- Understanding large-scale security monitoring systems
- Learning cloud platform architecture
- Interpreting security logs and alerts

Solutions:

- Continuous practice and self-learning
- Guidance from mentors and trainers
- Hands-on exercises and demonstrations
- Reviewing technical documentation

The overall experience prepared the foundation for future learning and career opportunities in cybersecurity.

6. IMPACT OF INTERNSHIP

The internship had a major impact on both personal and professional development. It provided an opportunity to experience real-world cybersecurity practices and understand how enterprise organizations operate in a technology-driven environment.

6.1 Academic Impact

The internship helped connect theoretical academic concepts with practical industry applications. Subjects studied during engineering coursework such as computer networks, programming, operating systems, and cybersecurity concepts became easier to understand when observed in practical scenarios.

The exposure to real-world tools and workflows improved technical understanding beyond classroom learning.

6.2 Professional Development

The internship improved professional qualities including:

- Communication Skills
- Professional Etiquette
- Teamwork
- Time Management
- Responsibility
- Technical Confidence

Understanding workplace expectations and organizational culture was one of the most valuable aspects of the internship.

6.3 Career Development

The internship strengthened interest in cybersecurity and cloud security domains. Exposure to enterprise security tools and threat monitoring systems helped in understanding potential career paths such as:

- Security Analyst
- SOC Analyst
- Cloud Security Engineer
- Threat Analyst
- Cybersecurity Consultant

The experience also highlighted the importance of continuous learning in cybersecurity because threats, tools, and technologies evolve constantly.

6.4 Confidence Building

Working with industry-standard tools and participating in practical activities increased confidence in handling technical concepts and enterprise technologies.

The internship also improved:

- Decision-making ability
- Logical thinking
- Technical adaptability
- Independent learning capability

Overall, the internship played a significant role in shaping technical understanding and professional readiness for future opportunities in the cybersecurity industry.

7. CONCLUSION

The cybersecurity internship at Cognizant was an extremely valuable learning experience that provided both technical exposure and professional development. The internship helped in understanding the practical implementation of cybersecurity concepts, cloud technologies, enterprise monitoring systems, and security operations used in real-world organizational environments.

During the 3.5-month internship period, exposure was gained to multiple technologies and domains including Java, Python, computer networks, malware analysis, cloud computing, Microsoft Azure, AWS, Microsoft Defender, Microsoft Sentinel, and Splunk. The internship improved technical knowledge related to threat monitoring, security operations, incident analysis, and cloud security concepts.

The internship also strengthened analytical thinking, communication skills, teamwork, adaptability, and professional discipline. Exposure to enterprise workflows and industry-standard tools helped bridge the gap between academic learning and practical implementation.

One of the most important outcomes of the internship was gaining a deeper understanding of how organizations protect their systems and data from evolving cyber threats. The experience increased confidence in pursuing future opportunities in cybersecurity and motivated continuous learning in the field.

Overall, the internship successfully achieved its objectives and contributed significantly toward technical growth, professional readiness, and career development in cybersecurity.

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2. Microsoft Security Documentation for Microsoft Defender and Microsoft Sentinel
3. AWS Documentation and Cloud Fundamentals Learning Resources
4. Splunk Fundamentals Training Materials
5. Computer Networking Reference Materials
6. Cybersecurity Fundamentals Learning Modules
7. Malware Analysis and Threat Detection Learning Resources
8. Udemy courses on Subnetting and Routing Protocols
9. Self paced learning modules
10. Java Programming Reference Books and Tutorials
11. Python Programming Documentation and Tutorials
12. Technical sessions and learning resources provided during the internship at Cognizant

APPENDICES

Appendix A: Tools and Technologies Used

Programming Languages

- Java
- Python

Cloud Platforms

- Microsoft Azure
- Amazon Web Services (AWS)

Security and Monitoring Tools

- Microsoft Defender
- Microsoft Sentinel
- Splunk

Technical Domains

- Computer Networks
- Malware Analysis
- Cloud Computing
- Cloud Security
- Security Monitoring
- Threat Detection

Appendix B: Internship Duration

- Internship Duration: 3.5 Months
- Organization: Cognizant
- Role: Cybersecurity Intern
- Location: Siruseri, Chennai

Appendix C: Key Learning Areas

- Security Operations Concepts
- Cloud Security Fundamentals
- Malware Analysis Basics
- Incident Analysis Concepts
- Threat Monitoring Workflows
- Enterprise Cybersecurity Practices
- SIEM and Log Analysis
- Programming Fundamentals